

Prevalence Rates of Non-Communicable Diseases by Sector

The distribution of non-communicable diseases by sector is shown in Table 6.3.5. Higher prevalence rates for diabetes (10.4%), high blood pressure (10.3%), and high cholesterol (8.9%) were reported in the Urban sector compared to other sectors. The Rural sector reported higher prevalence rates for heart disease (2.5%), kidney disease (0.9%), and cancer (0.4%). Relatively higher prevalence rates for stroke (0.8%), epilepsy (0.6%), and asthma (2.5%) were reported in the Estate sector.

Table 6.3.5 : Prevalence Rates of Self-Reported Illnesses by Sector, 2024

Sector	Total Population	Diabetes	High Cholesterol	High Blood Pressure	Heart Disease	Kidney Disease	Thalassemia	Cancer	Stroke	Asthma	Epilepsy
Total	21,779,483	8.5	8.2	10.1	2.5	0.8	0.1	0.4	0.6	1.8	0.3
Urban*	3,817,786	10.4	8.9	10.3	2.4	0.5	0.1	0.3	0.4	1.4	0.2
Rural	17,096,040	8.3	8.3	10.1	2.5	0.9	0.1	0.4	0.6	1.9	0.3
Estate Rural**	865,657	4.4	3.6	8.2	2.4	0.5	0.1	0.3	0.8	2.5	0.6

*Although the 2024 Census collected information separately as urban and estate urban, here the two categories are combined and shown as urban.

** The sector identified as 'Estate' in the 2012 Census corresponds to the 'Estate Rural' category in the 2024 Census.

Non-Communicable Disease Prevalence Rates by Sex

The distribution of non-communicable diseases (NCDs) in Sri Lanka by sex is presented in Table 6.3.6. According to the data, the prevalence of NCDs is generally higher among the female population compared to the male population. With the exception of heart disease, kidney disease, stroke, and epilepsy, all other non-communicable diseases were reported more frequently among females.

Table 6.3.6 : Prevalence Rates of Non-Communicable Diseases by Sex, 2024

Non-Communicable Disease (NCD)	Male		Female	
	Number	Prevalence Rate	Number	Prevalence Rate
At Least One NCD	1,725,859	16.4	2,459,890	21.8
High Blood Pressure (Hypertension)	772,517	7.3	1,427,662	12.7
Diabetes	766,406	7.3	1,084,451	9.6
High Cholesterol	638,387	6.1	1,157,552	10.3
Heart Disease	282,539	2.7	251,941	2.2
Asthma	164,019	1.6	237,387	2.1
Kidney Disease	105,929	1.0	65,419	0.6
Stroke/Paralysis	73,088	0.7	55,308	0.5
Cancer	26,433	0.3	59,354	0.5
Epilepsy	36,984	0.4	28,024	0.2
Thalassemia	5,710	0.1	12,935	0.1

*Excluding the roofless population